NSRA Title XVII · Sec. 905 · Sec. 1710

America Can Build Again: Permits on a Clock, Costs in Public, Power from Dams We Already Have

The American Society of Civil Engineers grades U.S. infrastructure a **C**, with a $3.7 trillion ten-year funding gap. The country built about 888 miles of new high-voltage transmission in 2024, a fraction of what the grid needs. Title XVII applies lessons from Japan and China to build faster and cheaper, while keeping every substantive environmental, safety, labor, and tribal-consultation protection.

What it does

Provision	Draft text
Power existing dams	Only a small share of America's roughly 90,000 dams generate electricity. A revolving fund adds generation at non-powered dams and modernizes old hydropower, with dam safety fixed first (Sec. 1703)
Licenses on a schedule	FERC publishes one schedule for every federal decision on a hydropower license; total extensions capped at one year (Sec. 1704)
Inspect everything every 5 years	A Japan-style hands-on inspection of bridges, dams, and other covered assets at least every five years, with a public registry and required repairs (Sec. 1705)
Publish what it costs	Standard unit costs (per lane-mile, per kilometer of track, per megawatt) reported and benchmarked; projects far above the median must explain why; a public library of pre-approved standard designs (Sec. 1706)
Permits on a clock	One federal schedule per project on the Permitting Dashboard, limits on deadline extensions, and a 150-day window for lawsuits (Sec. 1707)
Grid backbone	A national high-voltage transmission backbone plan and 15% of grid funds for long-duration storage, including pumped hydro (Sec. 905)
Protect before disaster	Pre-disaster mitigation for wildfire, flood, and extreme heat restored and protected from administrative cancellation, with a rural set-aside (Sec. 1710)

Faster, not looser

Every section keeps substantive law intact: the Clean Water Act, Endangered Species Act, Federal Power Act conditions, State water-quality authority, labor standards, and tribal consultation. What changes is the clock and the transparency. Projects are funded inside existing allocations, with no new authorization fight.

Operative text: Title XVII (Secs. 1701–1710) and Sec. 905.